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Comprehensive Exams

Doctor of Education in Higher Education

Specialization in Technology and Learning

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QUESTION 1

Organizations in general have struggled to keep pace with change. The rapid pace of change has caused organizations (including K-12 schools, colleges, and universities) to rethink their core reasons for existence, including their values.

A. Research the topic of organizational values and prepare a set of guidelines that would be helpful to a leader of any organization.

The guidelines you should include:

1. A clear understanding of the importance of organizational values
2. How values should be developed in the organization
3. Who should participate in the process of developing organizational values
4. How values should be communicated throughout the organization
5. How values should be maintained throughout the organization

B. Explain how these guidelines can be applied to a specific organization and situation with which you are personally familiar. Be sure to indicate the organization you are discussing (e.g. K-12 public school, charter school, community/junior college, 4-year private/public college/university, etc.)

Remember to include bibliography of sources cited in your answer in APA format. Maximum length for Question 1 is 10 pages, excluding references.

QUESTION 2

A. Accepting the premise that leadership is primarily associated with human behavior:

1. Describe the historical development and evolution of leadership in the literature of educational research
2. Give examples of how these theories have impacted modern management and leadership practices.

B. Assume that you have been assigned to create new/effective leadership teams in your organization.

1. Describe the processes and practices you would use from examples you described in Part A to create and manage these new teams.

Remember to include bibliography of sources cited in your answer in APA format.

The maximum length for Question 2 is 10 pages, excluding references.

QUESTION 3

Part A: Quantitative Research Design (Be sure to answer all parts of the question)

A research team asks you to help design and implement a Quantitative study to investigate whether there are statistically significant differences in test scores obtained from students who have in their classes been exposed to three different types of educational environments over the course of an academic year. One group from school A receives traditional educational instruction, another group from school B receives instruction enhanced by additional work with computers and the internet, while a third group from school C receives instruction enhanced by additional training in multi-cultural sensitivity. Approximately 60 participants will be obtained from each school. Participants will include only those whose parents or guardians grant permission for use of student records.

1. Identify and define the following:
 - a. the type of research design to be employed in the study
 - b. the independent and dependent variables
 - c. the type of sample to be collected.
2. Assuming that the dependent variable is measured on an interval scale, what statistical procedure (e.g. t-test, chi-square, etc.) would be most appropriate to evaluate the research question?
3. If the correct statistical test used to evaluate these data yields a p value (or the Sig. value in SPSS) of .040, what does that result indicate about the groups?

4. If the correct statistical test used to evaluate these data yields a p value (or the Sig. value in SPSS) of .895, what does that result indicate about the groups?

Part B: Qualitative Research Design (Be sure to answer all parts of the question)

A research team asks you to help design and implement a Qualitative study to investigate similarities and differences in perceptions of performance of students who have in their classes been exposed to three different types of educational environments over the course of an academic year. One group from school A receives traditional educational instruction, another group from school B receives instruction enhanced by additional work with computers and the internet, while a third group from school C receives instruction enhanced by additional training in multi-cultural sensitivity. Participants will include only those whose parents or guardians grant permission for use of student records.

1. Describe in detail how you would:

- a. Design your study
- b. Collect data
- c. Analyze data

2. Describe how each of the following key terms apply in the design of your study:

- a. Bracketing or Reflexivity
- b. Open Coding
- c. Axial Coding
- d. Triangulation

e. A gatekeeper Emic reporting

g. Etic reporting

Remember to include a bibliography of sources cited in your answer in APA format. The maximum length for Question 3 is 10 pages, excluding references.

Question 1

Several well-known social theorists with illustrious profiles, such as Emile Durkheim, George Mead, John Dewey, and Jurgen Habermas, have typically encouraged people to get involved in their communities and become knowledgeable in community activism to facilitate the relationships that exist between individuals in social groups and organizations (Current, 2003, p. 164; Gutek, 1988, p.78). The philosopher Herbert Spencer, who adopted Darwin's theories of social evolution, had argued that an individual needs change to survive. This was emphasized in his famous phrase, "survival of the fittest", which implies that change is constant and only the fittest social structures survive and thrive (Marion, 2002, p. 10). Similarly, an organization must adapt to change to survive. Organizations, such as colleges and universities, as well as business enterprises, have undergone paradigm shifts in the past decade that are having major repercussions, necessitating constant restructuring to meet the needs of all their stakeholders. A college organization such as Ohlone College is being forced to be more reflexive in its relationship to its environment and to also be responsible to multiple social forces rather than an autonomous site of higher learning (Robins & Webster, 2002, p. 45). Changes, such as those in the learning communities at Ohlone College, have forced organizations to rethink their core values for existence.

The importance of organizational values

In the context of organizational changes, management, divisions, departments, faculty, and the student body are undergoing demographic shifts, an ongoing process. In this context, organizations must embrace constructive changes to survive and grow. The reason for these changes must be compelling for them to be adopted and effective within these environments

(Komives, 2003, p. 286). The institution's stated mission, core values, and objectives would be closely aligned with changes in its environment to advance its visionary goals.

Clearer missions are essential to building a successful organization with respect to the pace of change needed to accomplish the vision of an integrated learning environment. A lot of organizations already have vision statements that describe what the organization might become. The purpose of a vision statement is to guide an organization toward a shared purpose. In the context of education, the vision provides clear guidance for day-to-day decision-making, ensuring people move in the right direction. The authors Jacoby and Jones (1996) implied that having a vision is about shaping the future and understanding “why” the organization exists. The mission provides the context for governance and decision-making processes in the way the school is managed. Vision and mission are the foundation of an organization. Strategic planning and meaningful goals are the foundations for effective practices to achieve the organization’s mission. The defined core values describe how people ought to comport themselves to make the vision a reality. In the context of development, the values enforced are those core values that people hold dear, that reinforce people’s sense of belonging and purpose in the direction of their work, and that create a foundation for increased commitment to organizational objectives (Winston, Creamer & Miller, 2001, pp. 399-403).

How values should be developed in the organization

The values of an organization are set on governing principles which the organization can always rely upon. The “how” challenges people within the organization to identify the specific attributes, behaviors, and commitments they must demonstrate in executing their responsibilities to make the vision a reality. This requires people to understand their role in observing the agreed-upon ‘rules of conduct’. As Rebores (2001) has pointed out, ethical behaviors are

determined by good judgment, healthy experiences, humane societal conscience, and principle of proportionality. Professionalism, good attitudes, character, knowledge, skills, and actions are also considered significant factors in personal and interpersonal interactions in this environment (Marion, 2002, p.140). DuFour and Eaker (1998) suggested this approach:

1. Carefully review the school's vision statement.
2. Identify the attributes, behaviors, and commitments that must be demonstrated by the group to move the school closer to this vision.
3. Develop a draft of a statement of these attributes, behaviors, and commitments, limiting it to no more than 10 statements.
4. Arrange small-group meetings with colleagues to present task force findings, solicit feedback, and answer questions.
5. Revise initial draft as appropriate.
6. Continue small-group meetings and revisions until there is a strong consensus for the statements.
7. Present your findings to the entire staff and obtain their endorsement of the final product.

The leadership of an organization is entrusted with setting the standard for administrators, managers, faculty, students, and any other stakeholders, and challenges their members with the responsibilities. It begins with the leadership of an organization adhering to these governing principles by example.

Who should participate in the process of developing organizational values

As the authors Jacoby and Jones (1996) stated, "leadership needs to develop the skills of teamwork, consensus building, and group facilitation, as well as a belief that all in the organization have something to contribute to the vision creation and implementation process" (p.

402). Establishing a shared vision for empowering everyone is essential to the vision building process. As Winston (2001) stated, it is the leadership of the organization's responsibility to articulate the vision building process to the people in their organization. Nevertheless, vision clarity is essential to the success of the organization. The process of developing organizational values depends on the cooperation of all the people within the organization. Furthermore, authors Jacoby and Jones (1996) pointed out that vision is often taken for granted because it is an intangible objective best understood intuitively. The lasting consequences of reorganization are facilitating the continuous retraining of the members of individual and group responsibilities. In addition, adherence to the rules and core values of the organization requires monitoring.

How values should be communicated throughout the organization

Once the shared values are clearly defined, it takes the leadership at all levels in the organization to facilitate and work together with all the parties in the organization. A leader in the organization needs to assume the role of stewarding the values to keep them alive. It is important to keep discussing the shared values and guiding principles often as a reminder to all participants. People can collaboratively manage cohesive forms of communication and share input with other constituents, as well as demand uniform accountability. The shared values guide standard communication and the decision-making processes.

How values should be maintained throughout the organization

By empowering the people in the organization, leaders at all levels will help facilitate good and lasting relationships with all those involved in the organization to execute their shared vision. All the people in the organization are joint participants in the process of developing and maintaining defined organizational values. The structure of the organization is important in sustaining values through its adoption of training, planning, and equipping people throughout the

organization to live according to its shared vision and mission imperatives. The theorist Abraham Maslow (1954) talked about human needs (physiological, safety, belongingness and love, esteem, and self-actualization), saying that people and organizations need each other to execute the shared vision (Bolman & Deal, 2003, p. 117).

Industrialist Frederick Taylor, considered the father of Scientific Management, argued the theory that “one best system” is based on a hierarchical structure of an organization to splinter the tasks of problem solving. He goes on to say greater efficiency within the organization is gained when the workers are working towards the same goals (Marion, 2002, p. 22).

Ohlone College:

The Learning Communities

Two years ago, Ohlone College launched the learning community’s initiative, a major transformation in how the college thinks about teaching and learning. Learning communities intentionally restructured the curriculum in ways that bring students, faculty and disciplines together in more integrated and meaningful ways. This theoretical framework was based on the work of Senge (1996). He developed the concepts and applications of learning organizations and applied these ideas to a college model.

In a college learning model, faculty shape their teaching around the ways of thinking they want their students to develop and they design assessments that require students to demonstrate their deep thinking and understanding through application and use.

The “learning college paradigm” seeks to create a learner-centered institution where all stakeholders pursue lifelong learning and commit to innovation, creativity and risk taking. The theoretical base for learning communities is about making deep cognitive, neural and social

connections, and that learners learn best in collaborative learning environments where they actively engage in the social construction knowledge (Merriam & Caffarella, 1999, p. 69).

How values should be developed in the learning communities

Learning communities are a major, broad-based innovation that, because of its alteration of the traditional curriculum, can be thought of as the catalyst for transforming the entire institution and advancing the “learning college paradigm”. Learning communities unify the campus culture by bringing together professionals in different units of the campus that have distinct missions such as librarians, educational technologists, IT staff, counselors, to collaborate with educators and students in learning communities. Ohlone College (2005) core values include:

1. Support Conditions: The learning community finds resources, creates schedules and generates structures that reduce isolation for its member; it runs on policies that encourage greater autonomy, foster collaboration/communication, and provide for staff development.
2. Shared Personal Practice: Faculty and staff find help, support and trust as a result of developing productivity relationships with each other. Faculty and administrators tolerate (even encourage) debate, discussion and disagreement. They are comfortable sharing successes and failures. They praise and recognize triumphs and offer empathy and support for each other’s troubles.

Who should participate in the process of developing learning communities

As true learning communities, Ohlone College involves all people in the organization (faculty, staff, students, and stakeholders) in their decision-making process. Faculty and staff will have the authority and the associated responsibility to provide the leadership it takes to continually build community, improve instruction, and increase student access. Ohlone College

encourages and supports high level of faculty and staff leadership as well as students in the learning communities.

How values should be communicated throughout the learning communities

Learning communities are structures that intentionally merge the academic and social function of undergraduate experience. They promote learning environments that integrate the ways students learn, both inside and outside the classroom, and enable collaboration and partnerships between professionals in student affairs and educators. In addition, learning communities are structures that promote high levels of interaction and collaboration among students and faculty, and among students. Online Learning technologies, such as course management systems and synchronous and asynchronous communication tools, can greatly enhance learning communities by extending student-to-student interactions beyond the classroom and enabling collaborative learning online. Ohlone College communicates with the learning communities by maintaining ongoing open communication with faculty and other members of the college. All the people in the organization need to assume the role of stewarding values to keep them alive.

How values should be maintained throughout the learning communities

By empowering the people in the organization, administrators, staff, faculty, and students will help facilitate good and lasting relationships with all those involved in the organization to execute their shared vision. All people in the organization are joint participants in developing and maintaining the organization's defined values. The desire for this type of learning, and for all stakeholders in a campus community to think and act systemically, will trigger the necessary collaborative partnerships between academic and student affairs divisions, enabling students to

see the academic and social dimensions of the college as integrated. Ohlone College maintains the learning communities by:

1. Sharing information freely and helping others utilize their talents to the fullest
2. Respecting the right of others to a safe and free learning environment
3. Being flexible and open to many ideas about how people learn.
4. Having all the people in the organization bound by a professional standard of ethics
5. Having a citizen of the community who is responsible for both fostering commitment to lifelong learning and for participating in the community.
6. Assuming responsibility for their learning and the learning of others around them
7. Being willing to take turns in leadership
8. Maintaining rules and regulations for instructors be prepared, know your subject, and prepare your classes.
9. Maintaining rules and regulations for students be prepared, do the homework, take the necessary prerequisites, and be attentive.
10. Maintaining rules and regulations for administrators: enforce the rules but otherwise get out of the way.

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Question 2

The historical development and evolution of leadership in the literature of educational research

Leadership teachings of the past decade and the last century have offered a great deal of advice from many perspectives on how best to build an organization for today. From their successes and failures, they have provided many important lessons for today's leadership and will continue to shape future leadership. Today's leadership role shifts from a group leadership model to one that places much more responsibility and accountability in individuals' hands. The work mode of the future will be more individual-centered than group-centered, with considerable self-determination and higher levels of shared-goal collaboration (Bieber et al., 2002).

Historically, leadership has evolved for centuries. In the era of Spencer's "Social Darwinism" (Marion, 2002, p. 194), the opening years of the 20th century represented the dawn of a new age, when the old world gave way to the new that started the Industrial Revolution during the major paradigm shifts in technology, socio-economic, and cultural change. The revolution spurred factory workers and their machines to do more. As a result, the Machine theory emerged (Marion, 2002, p. 21). Frederick Taylor, the Industrialist, considered the father of Scientific Management, in his famous handbook *Principles of Scientific Management* (1911) argued the theory that management's job was to identify the best way to train workers and to provide the supervision and monitoring needed to ensure that they would follow the prescribed methods (DuFour & Eaker, 1998, p. 20).

Modern organizational theory is rooted in Scientific Management and the human relations approach. It deals with the formal structure, internal workings, and external environment of complex human behavior within organizations (Marion, 2003, p. 195). Modern leadership and management also have to look toward results, respecting the qualities of each individual, with a

desire to help each individual grow, achieve, and fulfill potential. This perspective describes leadership as facilitating cooperative behavior, providing opportunities for personal growth, and addressing human needs (Gutek, 2002, p. 118). Similarly, Bolman and Deal (2003) explained that “The job of the leader is support and empower. Support takes a variety of forms: showing concern for people, listening to their aspirations and goals, and communicating personal warmth and openness” (p. 324). Modern organizational theories suggest that there is a relationship between organizations and human behavior, whereby interactions and relationships among individuals and the group within the organization influence behavior.

As most scholars agree, leadership is a complicated and expansive subject. In the literature on leadership and management, there are thousands of sources offering theoretical and practical insights. Most theories provide the same common framework for rules, laws, and principles. The practical aspects can be categorized by behavioral and personality styles. Theory and practice are the guiding principles for leadership. The classical scholars (Henri Fayol, Max Weber, and Fredrick Taylor) suggested a single best system, but most modern theorists believe there is no single best way to organize (Marion, 2002, p. 24).

Theories have impacted on modern management and leader practices

Based on Marion’s (2002) topology, modern leadership and management are impacted by Closed Systems theory, Open Systems theory, and Anti-Positivism. Specific theories include Machine Theory, Human Relations Theory, Structuralism Theory, Contingency Theory, Strategic Choice Theory, Population Ecology Theory, Culture Theory, Critical Theory, Institutionalism Theory, and Complexity Theory. All of these theories have profound effects on management and leader practices. They seem to agree on the strength of human behavior and its effects on leadership and management styles.

Closed Systems Theory is a combination of Machine Theory, Human Relations Theory, and Structuralism Theory. These theories focus on efficiency and effectiveness and are based on the presumption that organizations are largely self-contained entities, unaffected by external environmental forces. The advocates of this theory argue that decisions can be optimized, and that there is one best solution to a given problem (Marion, 2002, p. 27). Machine Theory focuses on hierarchical communication, excluding horizontal communication. Bureaucracy Theory is modeled around the organization's efficiency needs. This theory is related to Human Relations Theory in that human variability is controlled by rules. This approach conveys that systems are independent of environmental influences.

In contrast, Open Systems Theory simply holds that organizations are strongly influenced by their internal behavior and external environment. The internal behaviors of an organization refer to the activities, interactions, and sentiments of the participants. Seiler (1967) argues that a system's external environment comprises human forces, organizational forces, and technologies (Marion, 2002, p. 91). Human forces characterize population density, available skills, attitudes, cultural values, etc. Organizational forces characterize theories of organization, political requirements, competition, etc. Technological forces characterize available techniques and knowledge, finances and markets, materials and supplies, etc. (Marion, 2002, p. 93). Open Systems theorists suggest that organizational subsystems interact in complex ways with one another and with their environment. The environment also provides key resources that sustain organization and lead to change and survival.

As Marion (2002) describes, modern theories of organization are rooted in Open Systems Theory. Specific theories include Contingency Theory, Strategic Choice Theory, Population Ecology Theory, Culture Theory, Critical Theory, Institutionalism Theory, and Complexity

Theory. Although there is a great variety in the perspectives provided, they share the view that an organization's survival depends on its relationship with the environment.

Fred Fielder (1973) is considered the father of Leadership Contingency. Contingency Theory explains that group performance results from the interaction of two factors. These factors are known as leadership style and situational favorability. This theory suggests that an organization is structured in ways that best fit the environment in which it is embedded. Contingency theorists argue that, rather than seeking universal principles that apply to all or most organizations, analysts should identify contingency principles that reflect the demands of the particular types of task environments in which organizations operate (Marion, 2002, p. 134). An example of contingency thinking is the insight that bureaucracy is an organizational model that applies better to stable task environments than to volatile and uncertain ones. With respect to leadership and management, Fiedler (1973) suggests that a leader's effectiveness is determined by the degree of match between a leader's dominant trait and the situation's favorableness to the leader (Marion, 2002, p. 137). This suggests that the organization is effective when it is in tune with its contingent conditions and ineffective when it is out of tune with them. All else being equal, if an environment is stable and predictable, leaders can put together a rather simple organizational structure (Marion, 2002, p. 121).

Strategic Choice Theory assumes that leadership and management have significant choice over how they manage and adapt to changes in their external and internal environments. A changing external environment prompts leaders to adjust their idiosyncratic preferences—personal and impersonal forces. Strategic Choice theorists argue that decision-making is based on making adjustments to these factors, with the range of options well thought out, filtered, and constrained by values, beliefs, experiences, and leadership styles (Marion, 2002, p. 166).

Population Ecology Theory concerns adaptive preferences that respond to the stochastic forces of natural selection. This suggests that leadership and management need to develop routines to ensure reliability and accountability. Reliability and accountability require organizational structures that are highly reproducible. These reproductions of routines cause organizational inertia. Inertia is considered a consequence of selection. A balance is found at the niche's "carrying capacity" (Marion, 2002, p. 196).

Culture Theory states that its premise is increased effectiveness through strong cultures and engaged participants. O'Reilly and Chatman (1996) define culture as a "system of shared values and norms that define appropriate attitudes and behaviors for organizational members 'how to feel and behave'" (p. 160). They, like many researchers, see a relationship between culture and performance/attainment of organizational goals. As Marion (2002) has pointed out, "culture is not just ethnic or national. It is any stable order that emerges from interactive, social dynamics. When people interact, they influence each other's beliefs, understandings, behaviors, and perceptions of reality" (p. 225). Understanding differences between cultural values and work values, and between the organizational values of different groups at work, can be helpful when trying to implement change. This knowledge can also be helpful when developing culturally appropriate leadership and management practices.

Critical Theory is about control preferences and organizational control that can have a profound effect on people. Critical theorists argue that even the more humanistic approaches to management subjugate workers to the interests of rule elite. They suggest that leadership and management need to devise strategies for effectively controlling workers and enhancing their productivity. However, Critical Theory remains somewhat on the fringe of organizational theory because of its radical leaning (Marion, 2002, p. 254).

Institutional Theory is about social preferences. Institutional theorists see organizations as a means by which societal values and beliefs are embedded in organizational structure and expressed in organizational change (Marion, 2002, p. 228). Schein (1992) stated, “climate is the feeling that is conveyed in a group by the physical layout and the way in which members of the organization interact with each other, with customers, or with other outsiders” (Marion, 2002, p. 9). Leadership and Management seek to understand how cultural differences influence organizational patterns.

Chaos and Complexity Theories describe complex interactions involving large networks. Chaos is the general theory of interacting systems, while Complexity is derived from Chaos Theory, and is a specific theory of interactive and adaptive systems (Marion, 2002, p. 303).

Complexity Theory explains non-linear, dynamical systems. Most of nature is nonlinear and not easily predicted. For example, weather comprises many components that interact in complex ways, leading to unpredictability. Ecosystems, embryos, and the brain are other examples of complex, dynamical systems that are not easily explained by linear chains of causality (Marion, 2002, p. 304). However, applying Complexity Theory to the understanding of social organizations challenges the assumptions of linear relationships between contingencies and organizational structure and focuses on unpredictability and uncertainty in organizational behaviors.

Systems Theory suggests that leaders are designers, stewards, and coaches. In terms of organizational leadership, they need to view the organization as a system in which the parts are internally connected and externally connected to the external environment and clarify how the whole system can work better. In practice, leaders are responsible for building organizations, such as the design of the organization’s policies, strategies, and “systems”. From this

perspective, organizational leaders provide structures and integrate vision, mission, values, and goals. Leaders are responsible for designing the organization and empowering people throughout it to keep it running. In addition, they need to provide new skills of mentoring, coaching, and helping others to grow and become a new cadre of leaders, in addition to problem-solving and decision-making (Marion, 2002, pp. 313-314).

Create new/effective leadership teams

Of all the organizational theories described in this paper, it is clear that there is no single best theory for creating effective leadership teams. Similarly, there is no leadership style that is best suited for all organizations; rather, it depends on the organizational culture. Most theories address the formal structure, internal workings, and external environment of complex human behavior within organizations. The practical aspects can be categorized by behavioral and personality styles. Nevertheless, modern leadership and management literature suggests that the leadership role has shifted from a group-leadership concept to one that emphasizes teamwork and empowerment. Effective leadership teams focus on their team members, as team leaders who direct, coordinate, and control the work of others have been replaced by coaches, counselors, and facilitators. When creating effective leadership teams, the team leader must understand the team's intended purpose. By extension, it is critical that prior to creating leadership teams, the team leader must first understand the existing organizational culture.

Effective leadership teams are about team building. By definition, a team is a group of two or more entities linked by a common bond to achieve a shared goal. To operate effectively with teams, organizations must know how to create, use, and sustain them and their members.

Team building is essentially about finding the right people and designing an appropriate structure. It is important to note at this stage that creating and leading an effective team lies with

the team leader. First, the team leader is the team's designer. Second, the team leader determines the team's composition, structure, and members' roles. Third, the team leader develops the team's work processes and how team members will work together.

Bolman and Deal (2003) posed the following question as a guide for team building: What are we trying to accomplish? What needs to be done? Who should do what? How should we make decisions? Who is in charge? How do we coordinate efforts? What do individual members care about most: time, quality, and participation? What are the special skills and talents of each group member? What is the relationship between this group and others? How will we determine success? (Bolman & Deal, 2003, p. 96)

In shaping leadership teams, it is essential that the team leader understand the teamwork processes, including goals, roles, procedures, and interactions. The goal is the value-added work that each team can and should perform. The team needs to define the role each member, including the team leader, is expected to play and the requirements they must meet. The procedure is the mechanisms by which the teams do their work when they are together. The interaction is the patterns of behavior and operating principles.

After answering these questions and these concerns, the team leader should be better prepared to start developing leadership teams. The process of creating leadership teams includes identification, recruitment, and selection of leadership team members. Leadership team members provide leadership for the organization and help carry out its mission. They are people who have personal characteristics likely to lead to their success within the organization. Completing a position description with specific responsibilities, expectations, accountabilities, and scope of authority is critical and is a good first step. In recruiting candidates to leadership teams, the leadership should consider the following criteria: 1) academic training; 2)

employment history; 3) leadership skills; 4) cultural fit; 5) reputation; and 6) references. This process identifies the leadership style that fits the organization culture and other leadership team members. Contingency Theory can be used to select “best fit” leadership team members for leadership teams.

Once leadership teams are in place, the team leader needs to teach, coach, mentor, set expectations, and determine clear accountabilities for all leadership team members. Members should know exactly what is expected of them, and why they have been selected to the team. This opportunity is also to inform new leadership teams of the organization's goals and how teams will make those goals a reality. At this stage, the team leader may want to provide additional training in areas such as team building, organizational development, and multicultural diversity.

The next step in building effective leadership teams is to improve human resource management. Bolman and Deal (2003) suggested the following principles and practices:

1. Build and implement an HRM strategy: Develop a shared philosophy for managing people, build systems and practices to implement the philosophy
2. Hire the right people: Know what you want and be selective
3. Keep them: Reward well, protect jobs, promote from within, share the wealth
4. Invest in them: Invest in learning, create development opportunities
5. Empower them: Provide information and support, encourage autonomy and participation, redesign work, foster self-managing teams, promote egalitarianism
6. Promote diversity: Be explicit and consistent about the organization’s diversity philosophy, hold managers accountable

(Bolman & Deal, 2003, p. 136)

These principles and practices essentially say that organizations and people need each other to be successful. Similarly, it takes cooperative teamwork efforts to be successful.

The challenge to team effectiveness is the imbalance of power within teams that creates a volatile dynamic and complicates teamwork. Issues such as conflict are inevitable in the team environment. The effective way to address this concern is to create a policy team that addresses the team's dynamics and sets the policy and strategy for communications, information sharing, building understanding, etc.

All in all, creating effective leadership teams requires integrating team building and human resource management and establishing policies to address ongoing team dynamics. In addition, effective leadership teams communicate a clear mission and strategy, lead by example, set demanding yet realistic goals, maintain an open, communicative management style, and practice clear, careful strategic management. Finally, empowering people is vital to the team's success by fostering communication and collaboration throughout the team.

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Question 3

Part A: Quantitative Research Design

1. Identify and define the following:

The purpose of this study is to investigate whether there are statistically significant differences in test scores obtained from students who have, in their classes, been exposed to three different types of educational environments (traditional educational instruction, instruction enhanced by additional work with computers and the Internet, and instruction enhanced by additional training in multi-cultural sensitivity) over the course of an academic year.

Research Design

A quantitative experimental design will be employed, and participants will be randomly assigned to treatment and control groups. Traditional educational instruction is the control group. Instruction enhanced by additional work with computers and the Internet, and instruction enhanced by additional training in multicultural sensitivity, are the experimental groups (Gay, Mills & Airasian, 2006, p. 254).

Variables

The independent variable denotes different treatment conditions, with different groups receiving different treatments. In this study, there are three independent group variables, and they are defined by the “type of educational environment”: a) 1 = traditional; b) 2 = computer and the Internet; and c) 3 = multicultural sensitive.

The dependent variable is a variable which denotes a measurement on a coherent, scaled attribute, as defined by a score on that attribute. In this study, the dependent variable is defined as the “test score”.

Sample

Approximately 60 participants (i.e. students) will be randomly obtained from each school. Participants will include only those whose parents or guardians grant permission for use of student records. In this study, approximately 180 participants will be needed to carry out the research.

2. Assuming that the dependent variable is measured on an interval scale, what statistical procedure would be most appropriate to evaluate the research question?

The statistical procedure for comparing three independent groups (i.e., type of educational environment) on the dependent variable (i.e., test score) is called one-way ANOVA in SPSS. This is simply comparing the means of groups in order to make inferences about the population. One-way ANOVA is also called single-factor analysis of variance, because there is only one independent variable or factor. The independent variable has nominal levels (Gay et al., 2006, p. 359; Morgan, Leech, Gloeckner, & Barrett, 2007, p. 157). In this study, we will use the one-way ANOVA procedure, because we have one independent variable with three independent groups.

The level of measurement of the independent variable is defined as nominal, because there are three unordered categories (i.e. type of educational environment), and numerical values are simply to name the attribute uniquely.

The dependent variable is measured on an interval scale, where distances between levels are equal but there is no true zero.

3. If the correct statistical test used to evaluate these data yields a p value (or the Sig. value in SPSS) of .040, what does that result indicate about the groups?

Either 5 out of 100 or .05 is the typical alpha level that researchers use to assess whether the null hypothesis should be rejected or not (Gay et al., 2006, p. 343; Morgan et al., 2007, p. 92).

For $p = .04$, the result of this study is unlikely to be due to chance alone, because the p value is less than .05 (i.e., $p < .05$). The result suggests that there is a significant difference among the three types of educational environments (or treatment conditions) in test scores. However, we do not know which specific groups of means are significantly different, unless we do follow-up tests. Multiple comparisons can be used to determine which means are significantly different from one another (Morgan et al., 2007, p. 160).

4. If the correct statistical test used to evaluate these data yields a p value (or the Sig. value in SPSS) of .895, what does that result indicate about the groups?

For $p = .895$, the result of this study is likely due to chance alone, because p value is larger than .05 (i.e. $p > .05$). The result suggests that there is not a significant difference in average student test scores among the three types of educational environments (or treatment conditions) and that there is no evidence to suggest the difference and no further test is needed.

Part B: Qualitative Research Design

Research Design

Purpose

The purpose of this study is to investigate similarities and differences in perceptions of performance of students who have, in their classes, been exposed to three different types of educational environments over the course of an academic year.

Research Question

Are there similarities and differences between the types of environments (traditional educational instruction, instruction enhanced by additional work with computers and the Internet, and instruction enhanced by additional training in multi-cultural sensitivity) in regard to the perceptions of performance of students?

Method

A qualitative experimental design will be employed. Phenomenological methodology will be used to investigate similarities and differences between the types of environments with regard to perceptions of students' performance. This method reveals the meaning of our everyday existence. According to van Manen (1990), it is "the fulfillment of our human nature: to become more fully who we are" (p. 12). This perspective suggests that individuals reflect many of their sentiments regarding research inquiries and data analysis that observe the lives of individuals within their unique contexts (Creswell, 2007, p. 69).

In this study, the investigator/researcher (etic reporting) collects descriptions of behavior through observations, interviews, documents, and artifacts (Creswell, 2007, p. 131).

Site and Participant Selection

In this study, we will stratify a sample of 10 students by class from each of the three types of educational environments (traditional instruction, instruction enhanced by additional work with computers and the Internet, and instruction enhanced by additional training in multicultural sensitivity). The larger sample size may be used to ensure that smaller (or harder-to-reach) subgroups are still likely to be represented. However, a larger sample size may waste time, resources, and money. Creswell (2007) stated that in phenomenology, he saw the number of

participants range from 1 to 325 (p. 126). In this study, emic reporting is the participant themselves.

A gatekeeper may be used to contact potential participants for the study. Creswell (2007) suggested “bracketing” prior to the interview process.

Consent Form

To protect human subjects, all participants must have their parents or guardians review and sign a consent form prior to their participation in the study.

Interview Questions

In this study, we will ask all participants three open-ended questions across the three types of educational environments. The following questions are addressed:

1. How would you describe your school’s environment?
2. What do you already know about multicultural diversity?
3. What kinds of learning experiences do you have in your classroom, such as art, music, math, science, social studies, computers, and the Internet?

Analyze data

Phenomenological data analysis tends to follow specific structured methods. Creswell (2007) suggests three general approaches to analysis—Madison, Huberman and Miles, and Wolcott. In this study, we will use data analysis strategies by Wolcott, which suggest sketching ideas, reducing codes to themes, relating categories to an analytic framework in the literature, and displaying the data (Creswell, 2007, p. 149).

In addition, researchers can use several techniques discussed by Patten (2005) to establish the data's dependability and trustworthiness. Specific techniques include a) data triangulation; b)

methods triangulation; c) researcher triangulation; d) team of researchers with diverse backgrounds; e) interobserver agreement; f) peer review; g) auditor; and h) member checking.

In this study, we will use inductive analysis, which means that categories and patterns emerge from the data rather than being imposed on it prior to data collection (McMillan, 2001, p. 462). We will also use open coding and axial coding. In addition, we will use triangulation to establish the dependability and trustworthiness of the data.

Before we begin analyzing the data, we will need to transcribe the interviews. Initially, we will use hand coding of the transcripts using paper-and-pencil methods, and a codebook will be constructed, revised, and used throughout the data analysis to record emerging concepts and subcategories.

Qualitative data includes structured text, unstructured text, audio recordings, video recordings, etc. Creswell (2007) suggests that Computer-Assisted Qualitative Data Analysis Software (CAQDAS) is very helpful in computerizing the analysis of text and image data (p. 168). Creswell goes on to list the following advantages of using computers as a tool to accomplish qualitative research:

1. Provides an organized storage system.
2. Can help researchers locate material quickly and easily.
3. Encourages researchers to look closely at the data line by line.
4. Concept mapping feature enables the researcher to visualize relationships by drawing a visual model.
5. Allows a researcher to easily retrieve memos associated with codes, themes, or documents (Creswell, 2007, p. 165).

2. Describe how each of the following key terms apply in the design of your study:

Bracketing or Reflexivity

Bracketing, reflectivity, or epoche are concepts in which researchers set aside their experiences as much as possible to take a fresh perspective on the phenomenon under examination (Creswell, 2007, p. 59). These ideas suggest that researchers should set aside what they know about the student, so it does not influence their study results.

Open Coding

Open coding is the first step in the data analysis process. It involves taking the students' interview transcripts and segmenting them into information categories. This suggests that researchers should develop a small set of categories and gradually reduce their number until the data coalesce into themes for the study (Creswell, 2007, p. 64).

Axial Coding

Axial coding is the second step, following open coding. In this step, researchers take the categories from open coding, identify one as a central phenomenon among the types of environments, and then return to the database to identify the cause of the phenomenon (Creswell, 2007, p. 237). This suggests that categories are systematically developed and linked with subcategories.

Triangulation

This is the process of using multiple data collection methods and sources to obtain a more complete picture of what is being studied and to cross-check information. The strength of qualitative research lies in collecting information in multiple ways, rather than relying on a single method. Often, two or more methods can be used so that the weakness of one is compensated for by the strength of the other (Creswell, 2007, p. 208). For example, interviews with students may help us understand what we observe happening in a learning environment.

Gate keeper

A gatekeeper is an informant or participant who allows the researcher to observe and spend time talking with participants in the study (Creswell, 2007, p. 68). A gatekeeper is essentially a person who helps the researcher to get in contact with the students.

Emic reporting

Emic (participant) reporting is when an insider participant observes the study and retells the story of what happened during the interview (Creswell, 2007, p. 72).

Etic reporting

Etic (researcher) reporting is very similar to Emic reporting. Etic reporting is by an outsider participant who explains the observer's role to the participants (i.e., students) (Creswell, 2007, p. 72).

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Comps Results

From: Suzanne Power <spower@alliant.edu>

To: Jim Pham <jpham0507@gmail.com>,

Date: Dec 15, 2007 2:40 PM

Subject: Comps Results

Mailed-by: alliant.edu

Dear Jim,

The Graduate School of Education Comprehensive Exam Faculty Review committee is pleased to report that you have passed both the Concentration Exam in Educational Leadership and Management and Core Exam in Research. You are now eligible to register for GSE 9901.

The Graduate School of Education (Educational Leadership/Higher Education) has resumed the practice of conducting GSE 9901(the first dissertation course) as a class that meets regularly (instead of as an independent study). I will be contacting you with information on registration and the class meeting dates.

On behalf of the Graduate School of Education faculty, I congratulate you on reaching this milestone in your doctoral study. I wish you continued success as you enter the dissertation coursework.

Sincerely,

Dr. Suzanne Power

Systemwide Director, Educational Leadership